

Yue Yao

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Interdisciplinary researcher focused on embodied AI, robotic co-design, and algorithmic accountability. Combines Data Science and AI training at Columbia with research in human-robot interaction and regulatory responsiveness, and institutional AI workflows.

EDUCATION

Columbia University, SIPA & Columbia Business School

M.I.A. / M.B.A. | Focus: Data Science & Artificial Intelligence

Relevant coursework: Machine Learning, Robotics Studio, Computer Graphics, Robotics Foundations; Building AI Tools with LLMs, AI for Policy, Database Design.

Expected May 2028

New York, NY

University of Oxford

M.St., History of Art and Visual Culture

Oct 2020 - Jul 2021

Oxford, UK

University of British Columbia

B.A. (Honours), Art History

Sep 2016 - May 2020

Vancouver, Canada

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Columbia University, Creative Machines Lab

Research Collaborator, Creative Robotics & Embodied AI

- Conduct collaborative research in robotic co-design, simulation, embodied AI, and human-robot interaction.
- Co-authored *Locomotion Selects for Symmetry*, comparing evolutionary morphology search and reinforcement-learning control in abstract and CAD-informed simulations; submitted to an IROS workshop.

Jun 2026 - Present

New York, NY

United Nations

Data and AI Fellow

- Support AI-enabled workflows for crisis-response financing and institutional analysis using Python, LLM tools, and structured data pipelines to synthesize unstructured reports.

Jun 2026 - Present

New York, NY

TouchTronix Robotics

Data Science Intern

- Evaluated companion-robot applications and market opportunities; translated embodied-AI research into product strategy.

May - September 2026

New York, NY

China Europe International Business School (CEIBS)

Research Assistant, Management Science

- Authored business cases and white-paper research on entrepreneurship and internationalization; built an experiential UI/UX platform for management education.

Mar 2024 - Aug 2025

Shanghai, China

Shanghai Pudong Development Bank (Headquarters)

Management Associate

- Developed policy frameworks across 34 regions and SQL-based talent dashboards supporting workforce planning.

Aug 2022 - Mar 2024

Shanghai, China

SELECTED RESEARCH & PROJECTS

ReTracing: Body, Machine & Generative Systems

Co-first Author | NeurIPS Creative AI / CVPR Art Gallery

- Co-architected a language-to-motion pipeline for a human performer and Unitree Go2 quadruped, reconstructing interactions as 3D traces; applied SAM-based segmentation and shared the research workflow.

May 2024 - Dec 2025

New York / Pittsburgh

AI Governance, Institutional Visibility & Financial RAG Systems

Data Analyst, Network Analysis & AI Validation

- Built policy and cultural datasets using graph analysis, entity resolution, and Python/Tableau; developed an evidence-grounded SEC 10-K RAG system with retrieval, risk classification, and abstention logic.

Dec 2025

New York, NY

Oxford China Forum & Entrepreneurship Club

Panel Director & Executive Member

- Curated AI, art, and entrepreneurship events engaging 200+ participants.

Aug 2020 - May 2021

Oxford, UK

SELECTED PAPERS, CASES & EXHIBITIONS

- Jianing Fan*, **Yue Yao***. *Who Gets Heeded? An Obligation-Level Audit of Responsiveness in EPA Rulemaking*. ACM EAAMO 2026 - accepted for oral presentation.
- Jiong Lin, **Yue Yao**, Hod Lipson. *Locomotion Selects for Symmetry: Evolutionary Co-Design of Legged Robots on an Icosahedral Body*. Submitted to an IROS workshop.
- Yitong Wang*, **Yue Yao***. *ReTracing: An Archaeological Approach Through Body, Machine, and Generative Systems*. NeurIPS 2025 Creative AI Track; CVPR 2026 Art Gallery.
- **Yue Yao**, Yitong Wang. *Unveiling Bodies*. ICSR 2026 Grand Challenge - Art finalist.
- Jean Lee, **Yue Yao**. *Entering Africa: Challenges Faced by Lü Cuifeng, CEO of CJ Smart Cargo Group*. Award-winning CEIBS case, 2025 Global Contest for the Best China-Focused Cases.
- Research contributor, CEIBS *Internationalization of Family Business* white paper (2024): Teckwah and Brico Group cases.

* Co-first authors; equal contribution.

SKILLS

Technical: Python, R, SQL, Bash, MATLAB, Tableau, Excel/VBA, machine learning, NLP/LLM workflows, data visualization

AI/Robotics: Embodied AI, robot learning, human-robot interaction, multimodal data pipelines, diffusion/imitation learning

Languages: Chinese and English fluent; Japanese and Latin basic.